

Element L

Throughout the project in which we were tasked with creating an enrichment device for the Andean Bears of the Nashville Zoo. We ran into some major obstacles along the way but were able to problem solve and eventually get around them.

Our biggest issue was finding materials suitable for our design ideas. Originally we came up with multiple designs featuring a spherical shape, but encountered trouble finding anything large enough that was both safe for the bear and would hold against it. This became so much of a problem we had to switch our design to a cylindrical shape, although we kept a similar base idea for the distribution of the food. One thing we could have changed is researching the materials before and we could have cut out the spherical designs earlier in the process.

With this problem came a later order of the cylindrical design which did not give us much time to work with our final design. For a while all we could do was modify our cardboard prototype. Our advice would be to do the research thoroughly beforehand so it doesn't lead to unforeseen problems later in the process.

Another slight problem we ran into was in the closing couple weeks different members of the would be off doing college visits or taking AP tests and would miss the day. We'd recommend making group chat like we did to keep in constant communication and so everyone is on the same page as one another.

Although we ran into these caveats, the timeline we made with self proposed deadlines on specific elements and prototypes helped us at least keep on track to some degree and didn't get too far behind. In the end we were able to deliver a working product to the zoo which they expressed excitement about our design.

Other than these main problems we functioned well as a group with each person contributing in different ways and giving different ideas to the table. This helps us as we move on to college or other walks of life as we learn to effectively utilize all the resources given to us and get any help we can from our superiors.